



Smart Goal

A guide for young people

Setting goals is a powerful way to direct your energy and focus on what you want to achieve. For young people, having clear goals can be especially helpful for navigating school, hobbies, personal development, and future aspirations. The SMART framework is a fantastic tool to ensure your goals are well-defined and achievable.

SMART is an acronym that stands for:

- **Specific:** What exactly do you want to achieve? Be clear and detailed.
- **Measurable:** How will you know when you've achieved your goal? What are the indicators?
- **Achievable:** Is this goal realistic given your current resources, skills, and time?
- **Relevant:** Does this goal align with your values and other long-term objectives?
- **Time-bound:** When will you achieve this goal? Set a deadline.

By applying these five criteria, you can transform vague aspirations into concrete action plans. This not only makes your goals more attainable but also increases your motivation and sense of accomplishment along the way.

Why SMART Goals Matter for You

Think about it: if you just say, 'I want to get better at soccer,' it's hard to know where to start or when you've succeeded. But if you set a **Specific** goal like, 'I want to improve my penalty kicks,' and make it **Measurable** by tracking how many shots I make in a practice session, you're already on the right track.

An **Achievable** goal means not aiming to play in the World Cup next week if you're just starting out, but maybe aiming to make the school team next year. A **Relevant** goal might be improving your grades if you want to get into a specific college program. And finally, a **Time-bound** goal gives you a target, like 'I want to be able to run a mile without stopping in 8 weeks.'

Using SMART goals helps you:

- **Focus Your Efforts:** You know exactly what you're working towards.
- **Stay Motivated:** Seeing progress makes you want to keep going.
- **Manage Your Time:** You can break down bigger goals into smaller, manageable steps.
- **Celebrate Success:** You can clearly identify when you've reached a milestone.

Your SMART Goal Activity

Now it's your turn to put the SMART framework into action! Choose one area you'd like to improve or a new skill you'd like to learn. It could be related to school, a hobby, sports, a personal habit, or anything else that's important to you.

Follow these steps:

1. **Brainstorm:** What's something you want to achieve?
2. **Make it Specific:** Write down exactly what you want to accomplish.
3. **Make it Measurable:** How will you track your progress and know when you've succeeded?
4. **Make it Achievable:** Is this realistic for you right now? What steps can you take?
5. **Make it Relevant:** Why is this goal important to you? How does it fit into your bigger picture?
6. **Make it Time-bound:** When do you want to achieve this by? Set a clear deadline.

Example:

- **Vague Idea:** I want to read more.
- **SMART Goal:** I will read one chapter of a book every night before bed, for 30 minutes, for the next 4 weeks. I will measure this by noting down each chapter I finish. This is relevant because I want to improve my vocabulary and comprehension for my English class, and achieving this will help me feel more confident in discussions. I will set a deadline of 4 weeks from today to see how many books I can finish within this reading habit.

Now, write out your own SMART goal below:

My SMART Goal:

Specific: _____

Measurable: _____

Achievable: _____

Relevant: _____

Time-bound: _____

Wrapping Up Your Goals

Setting SMART goals is a skill that gets better with practice. Don't worry if your first attempt isn't perfect. The most important thing is to start the process and commit to working towards something that matters to you. Review your goals regularly, celebrate your successes (big or small!), and don't be afraid to adjust them if needed. Happy goal setting!